

Chapter – 13: The Value of Work

When you are doing any work, do not think of anything beyond. Do it as worship, as the highest worship, and devote your whole life to it for the time being. — Swami Vivekananda

- Anu, Kabir – playing in park – saw neighbour – Geeta Aunty – returning home in uniform – Pilot – Indian Air Force – pride of whole town
- Anu says – Aunt’s uniform – similar to dress at Kabir’s house – BUT – colour diff.
- Kabir says – that uniform – grandfather – retired from BSF – spends his time –
 - Free geography classes – neighbour kids
 - Tending to vegetable garden
 - Running errands for home
- Anu’s parents – run a shop – uniforms and ready-made garments
 - Appa – leaves early morning – Maa – joins later – after kids leave for school
 - Maa – usually back – before kids return from school
 - Also, volunteers – grp – teaches knitting
 - Elder brother – Rohan – software engineer – works in company – make computer applications
 - Weekends – volunteers – teach comp. skills – nearby college – youth development programme
- Kabir wonders – everyone around us – doing many things
- Diff. activities – divided – 2 grp. – *economic* and *non-economic*
- **Economic** – involve money – performed – exchange of money
- Example –
 - Business person – selling school bags – market
 - Farmer selling produce
 - Lawyer – asking for fee – fighting a case
 - Truck driver transporting goods
 - Employed workers
- **Non-economic** – do not generate income – out of feelings – gratitude, love, care, respect
- Example –
 - Parents cooking food, helping children for homework
 - Youth caring for grandparents
 - Family members – helping in renovation of house
- Anu’s, Kabir’s story – Geeta Aunty – Air Force Pilot – receive **salary** – serves country – economic activity also
- Anu’s brother – software engineer – receive salary
- Over weekend – volunteers – youth development programme – nearby college – non-economic activity

Types of Economic Activity

- Kavya – excited – going to her aunt’s house – Kamlapur village
- On the way – obs. – highway built – near village – construction site – very busy
- Large machines – excavators, bulldozers – operated – dedicated technicians
- New highway – promise – reduce travel time – nearest town – 5 hrs. to 2 hrs.
- Kavya thought – visiting aunt – easier now – new highway – reduce time
- Kavya – ran to her aunt – very happy – eat *jalebis* she made

- Joined by Kavya's uncle – just returned from work – technician – operates a bulldozer – receives a monthly salary
 - Next day – Kavya's aunt – woke up early – finish her chores
 - She – employed at – village post office – monthly salary
 - Evening – after office work – online classes – help – students – prepare for school exams – charges weekly fees
 - Weekend – Kavya – visited local mango orchard
 - She saw Sahil – farm labourer – using tractor – till a land nearby – earns a daily wage
 - Some payment – cash – rest – mangoes – equal value
 - Mangoes – received as payment – **payment in kind**
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- Economic activities – have value – in terms of money
 - These activities – also add value – each stage – value of addition
 - Example – Kavya's father – Rajesh –
 - Rajesh – carpenter – buys food – nearby market – ₹ 600
 - Uses – special tools, other materials – build furniture
 - Sells the chair for ₹ 1000
 - Wood for chair – ₹ 600 – sold for – ₹ 1000
 - Diff. – ₹ 400 – monetary value – Rajesh's skill, time, effort
 - Buying wood to selling chair – activities – involve payment – part of economic activities

The Importance of Non-Economic Activities

- These activities – do not involve money – value generated – imp.

Seva: selfless service

- *Seva* – many places – temples, gurudwaras, mosques, churches
- *Langars* – comm. kitchens – gurudwaras – serve food – every visitor – free
- These practices – foster – sense of satisfaction, gratitude
- Also – way of contributing to society – without expecting anything

The strength of community participation

- Swachh Bharat Abhiyan – collective efforts – all Indian citizens – keep surroundings clean
- Individually – keep homes, surroundings – clean
- People – come together – clean streets, roads, parks, other public places
- Together – efforts – clean home, neighbourhood, society, nation
- Another example – collective community – Van Mahotsav – promote awareness – value of trees – conservation of forests
- Initiative – brings together members – tree plantation drives